

UTT Chapter 01 Assignment

Hello!

Well, I'm finally settled into my dorm room. You wouldn't think that it would take so long to move into a room the size of a closet, but when you're sharing that space with a roommate, you have to be creative.

My roommate, Nathan, is really interesting. After noticing my Bible, he mentioned that he is taking a World Religions class this semester. It sounded like a fascinating class, so I signed up too! My course load this semester is fairly light since it is my first semester and all. In addition to World Religions, I am taking English Composition, Art History, Economics, and Basket Weaving. (Don't laugh!)

Yesterday was the first day of classes. I was really nervous, but I got through it. My World Religions professor is hilarious. He dresses like a hippie and even brought a ukulele to class. It will probably be my most fun course this term. When he began his lecture, he asked each of us to say what religion, if any, we believe in. Many of the students said they believed in Christianity, but a number of them held to Islam, Judaism, and even atheism. Nathan said he was "into spirituality," but I have no idea what he meant by that. I'll have to ask him sometime.

Anyway, back to the lecture. The professor gave a brief rundown of what he called the major "worldviews." Despite my confusion, everyone seemed to understand what that meant, so I didn't ask since I didn't want to look ignorant. He proceeded to say that by the end of the semester, most of the professed Christians would believe something different. Needless to say, I was shocked. After class, I asked the professor why he expected that to happen. We talked for a while before the professor asked me if I thought Christianity was the only way to God. I answered yes, since Christianity is the only religion that acknowledges Jesus as both God and Savior. The professor proposed a different view. He thought that all religions ultimately lead to God. He argued that ultimately religions are just different paths to the same destination. I stammered out a short reply, saying that not all religions believe in Jesus, but it didn't seem to satisfy him. He asked what I knew about other religions, and I admitted that I did not know much. The last thing he said has really had me thinking the last few days. He said, "If you don't know what other religions believe, then how do you know that other religions don't lead to God as well?" I didn't know what to say.

I'd like to be able to defend my faith to him, but the questions he asked made me wonder if I've thought through my beliefs carefully. My professor said he's open to talking about Christianity, but I don't think I know just how to explain it to him. Can you help me figure out what to say? **What is a worldview?** Can you also explain to me **why should we study worldviews?** I mean, I know I should since he pointed out how little I know, but I don't know if I could really say why. He's interested in learning about my beliefs, but **what does it mean to have a Christian worldview?**

Well, it's already past midnight, so I'd better get some sleep. I have a class at 8 a.m. tomorrow and can't skip breakfast if I want to have my brain awake that early!

One last thing ... **do you know why you are a Christian?** I know I am, but after my conversation with the professor, I am not sure I know *why* I am. Just curious.

-Doug